

Smartwatches: To buy or not to buy

Before we start off, let us get one thing straight, a smartwatch is not a new product by any means. While it is the rave in tech town nowadays, if anything, this is the second iteration of smartwatches in the country. Do we have a point here? Indeed we do. When buying a smartwatch, you should not look at it as something completely new that you are experimenting with, rather, you should take the same approach as the average consumer takes with most other things—budget and want. Yes, the two basics that keep popping up in economics textbooks

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When it comes to smartwatches, it is very difficult to determine a need for the device. While wearables will, without a doubt, become needed devices in future, currently they remain a matter of want. Not taking anything away from their functionality and usefulness, you need a smartphone, but you can get by without a smartwatch.

The general features of a smartwatch include reading messages, taking calls, setting alarms on your phone, amongst others. These devices come as companions for your smartphone. They connect to your phone using technologies such as Bluetooth or NFC and offer various functions, because of which you would not even have to pull your smartphone out of your pocket often.

Moving on, there are quite a few



options on offer. The Samsung Galaxy Gear and Sony Smartwatch 2 are perhaps the best known devices in this segment. Moreover, if you have the budget, you can go for the current unanimous winner of the smartwatch segment, the Pebble Steel. Yes, they do ship to India. So, if price is not a constraint for you, then get your hands on one of these.

Coming back to our territorial borders though, the Galaxy Gear is priced at ₹ 22,990, which frankly is a

little steep in our opinion, especially when combined with the fact that it only works with a handful of Galaxy smartphones. Way to pull off an Apple, Samsung!

The Sony Smartwatch 2 SW2 is first the best example of why smartwatches are not new. This device is an upgraded version of the company's first Smartwatch. The Smartwatch 2 is priced at ₹ 14,990 and works with all Android phones (with Android 4.0 or above). Make a note of this, because this is a huge plus for Sony. Not only do you not have to worry about what phone you

SOME SMARTWATCHES TO CHOOSE FROM

Samsung Galaxy Gear	Sony Smartwatch 2	Sony Smartwatch	Burg 13	Casio G Shock	Pebble Steel
					
Price: ₹ 22,990	Price: ₹ 14,990	Price: ₹ 7,990	Price: ₹ 14,235 on flipkart.com	Price: ₹ 9,495	Price: ₹ 15,160 on getpebble.com
▶ Bluetooth ▶ 4.1cm (1.63-inch) super AMOLED display ▶ 800MHz dual-core processor ▶ Samsung apps ▶ Accelerometer and gyroscope ▶ 1.9-megapixel camera ▶ HD video playback and recording	▶ Works as an NFC watch with all smartphones using Android 4.0 (Ice Cream Sandwich) and later ▶ Bluetooth 3.0 ▶ Android release: 4.0 and later ▶ Charging with micro USB ▶ Water resistant IP57	▶ Battery lasts for a week on low usage and one day on heavy usage ▶ USB charging ▶ 3.3cm (1.3-inch) OLED display ▶ Bluetooth 3.0	▶ Bluetooth ▶ Front camera ▶ SMS and MMS ▶ Micro-SD card slot	▶ Bluetooth ▶ Call and SMS alerts ▶ Works with iPhone 4S and iPhone 5	▶ 5ATM waterproof ▶ Tri-colour LED ▶ Daylight readable display ▶ Notifications ▶ Apps ▶ 5-7 day battery ▶ Works with both iOS and Android devices